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NVIDIAs GTX 275 makes a splash with very competitive prices and performance just behind the GTX 285



Seagate's new 5400.6 Momentus notebook drives pack up to 250 GB on a single platter

Q My PC configuration is an Intel Core 2 Duo E8400, MSI P7NGM-Digital motherboard, 2X2 GB Corsair XMS2 RAM, CoolerMaster 600 Watts Xtreme Power PSU. I want to buy a 22-inch LCD monitor and a graphic card. I have decided upon Dell 2209WA and ZOTAC 9800 GTX+ AMP Edition or an MSI 9800 GTX+ T2D512. Can I get anything better for a budget of Rs. 25,000? And please help me decide upon the graphic card. My basic requirement is gaming and multimedia. I would also be using Photoshop and Maya.

Charles Peter, Ghaziabad

The Dell 2209WA is a good monitor by all accounts, but why spend around Rs. 15,000 on a 22-inch monitor from Dell when you can spend Rs. 10,000-12,000 on other 22-inch monitors from brands such as Acer and ViewSonic. Instead of a GeForce 9800 GTX+ you could spend a little more, say up to Rs. 17,000 and get yourself an ATI Radeon HD 4870, which is a much faster card. With a monitor priced at Rs. 10,000, this just exceeds your budget by Rs. 2,000 but will be more future proof.

Q My PC configuration is as follows: Intel Core 2 Duo 4400 @ 2.0 GHz, Dynet 2 GB @ 667 MHz DDR2, Intel D945GCNL Motherboard, LG 17-inch Flatron. Please suggest a good graphics card below Rs.3000?

Mohit Shah

I recommend a graphics card based on the GeForce 9400GT chipset. Brands to look at are Palit, ZOTAC, EVGA and MSI. These should be the slightly cheaper priced cards available. Expect to pay anywhere between Rs. 2,800 and Rs. 3,400. Try to get a card with 512 MB of video memory.

Q My configuration is as follows: P4 HT 2.8GHz, Intel 865 GVHZ board, 1GB 444 MHz RAM, 400W power supply. Can I add a graphics card to my board as there is no AGP slot present. I only see PCI slots. I also asked several vendors for a PCI graphics card, but they told me that the result or performance of a PCI graphics card is not good. Should I increase the RAM or is there a solution for graphics on my board? Budget is not a problem. Can I overclock this board?

Bhushan Nandane

I have one word of advice for you – upgrade! Components are at all time low prices and you can pick up a reasonably fast configuration for around Rs. 25,000 without a monitor, which you no doubt already have. In case you do not want to upgrade there are a couple of very costly options for you. The PCI version of the GeForce 6200 GPU is available but it'll cost you Rs. 4,000, or

thereabouts, and is priced higher than the PCIe version of a GeForce 9400GT, which is a much newer card. Increasing the RAM will do little to make your current configuration faster. DDR RAM is also double the price of DDR2 RAM. Your PC is sadly outdated and I reiterate – upgrade it.

Q I want to buy a good, cheap, value-for-money large capacity hard disk, preferably an internal one, which I want to use externally since I have no available power supply to spare. Please suggest a hard disk for me and also what I need to buy in order to convert it into a temporary external solution.

Eric Pereira

All 3.5-inch external solutions need an external power supply. In case you want an external solution without the need of a power supply, you can look at 2.5-inch external solutions that draw all the power they need from the USB port. I'd suggest a 320-GB external solution priced at around Rs. 4,500. In case you want something really colossal, to the tune of 1 TB or more, then you had better stick to a 3.5-inch solution as these are cheaper. Buy the Seagate 1 TB 7200.11 series hard drive. Priced at Rs. 6,500 in the street, it's great value for money. Unfortunately, when you convert it to an external solution you will discover you need an external power connection. Why not buy a spike guard to solve this problem? For the external case (in case you are buying an internal drive) look at vendors such as Zippy and Transcend, their cases are decent.

Q I want to buy a high-end graphics card – which one is better, the GTX 295 or Radeon HD 4870 x2?

The GeForce GTX 295 is the newer and faster card. It should be priced at Rs. 35,000 or so. Look for brands such as EVGA, Palit, ZOTAC and MSI. These are priced slightly lower than brands such as ASUS, Gigabyte and XFX.

Q I Want To Buy an MFD with good print quality. My budget is around Rs. 10,000. Please suggest something. Can I print photographs with such a printer?

Pawan Maurya



Canon MP 486

In case you do not need the additional fax feature, look at the Canon MP 486, available at a price of Rs. 8,495. It's a good printer and will satisfy the need for a photo printer as well.

Q My current configuration is: Intel P4 (3.0 GHz), MSI G31M3, 2X2GB DDR2 800, XFX 9500GT 512 MB, Samsung 320GB (SATA), Odyssey 450 W PSU. I upgraded to this configuration around a month back. I played games such as Crysis, Prince of Persia, NFS Undercover at minimal resolution. I want to play at higher quality settings without getting my system to hang. I'm totally confused in choosing the processor (Q6600 / Q8200).



Corsair VX450

Please help me to choose any one among these processors and also a better solution for the power supply. I have a budget of Rs. 10,000.

Dhamodharen Sundar

Your PSU is unable to supply the required power and for this reason your PC is hanging. First, I recommend you upgrade your power supply to a Corsair VX 450 – that should cost you around Rs. 4,000. After that, upgrade your graphics card to a GeForce 9600 GT. This will make a huge difference to the performance. Such a card will set you back around Rs. 6,000. Next, please upgrade your CPU. I recommend buying at least a Core 2 Duo E7400. Priced at Rs. 6,000 this CPU will reduce the bottleneck on your GPU.

Q I'm planning to buy a netbook. My budget is Rs.25,000. I'm going to use it for basic multimedia (watching HD movies and playing music), work on PowerPoint and Excel, and surf the net. Which is the best one I can get around Bangalore at the given budget?

Arnie Adderstone

I don't think any netbooks are powerful enough to allow you watch any kind of HD content on them, but for regular DVD movies you should be covered. Do remember that netbooks do not have an optical drives. I recommend ASUS' EEPIC 1000HA that has a 10-inch display. Alternatively you could look at the Acer Aspire One D150. Both these netbooks should be around the Rs 25,000 mark on the street. ■